

016. Chapter 2 Verses 45-47

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.45

त्रैगुण्यविषया वेदा निस्त्रैगुण्यो भवार्जुन ।
निर्द्वन्द्वो नित्यसत्त्वस्थो निर्योगक्षेम आत्मवान् ॥ 45 ॥

*trai-guṇya-viṣhayā vedā nistrai-guṇyo bhavārjuna
nirdvandvo nitya-sattva-stho niryoga-kṣhema ātmavān*

trai-guṇya—of the three modes of material nature; **viṣhayāḥ**—subject matter; **vedāḥ**—Vedic scriptures; **nistrai-guṇyaḥ**—above the three modes of material nature, transcendental; **bhava**—be; **arjuna**—Arjun; **nirdvandvaḥ**—free from dualities; **nitya-sattva-sthaḥ**—eternally fixed in truth; **niryoga-kṣhemaḥ**—unconcerned about gain and preservation; **ātma-vān**—situated in the self

The first part of the Vedas (Karma Kanda) deal with material things pertaining to the three Gunas. One should transcend the three Gunas, become free from the operation of the pairs of opposites, take refuge in the pure sattvic state, and firmly establish himself in Atma.

VERSE 2.46

यावानर्थ उदपाने सर्वतः सम्प्लुतोदके ।
तावान्सर्वेषु वेदेषु ब्राह्मणस्य विजानतः ॥ 46 ॥

*yāvān artha udapāne sarvataḥ samplutodake
tāvānsarveṣhu vedeṣhu brāhmaṇasya vijānataḥ*

yāvān—whatever; **arthaḥ**—purpose; **uda-pāne**—a well of water; **sarvataḥ**—in all respects; **sampluta-udake**—by a large lake; **tāvān**—that many; **sarveṣhu**—in all; **vedeṣhu**—Vedas; **brāhmaṇasya**—one who realises the Absolute Truth; **vijānataḥ**—who is in complete knowledge

To an enlightened person who has known the Self, all the Vedas are of as much use as is a reservoir of water in a place where there is a flood.

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन ।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि ॥ 47 ॥

karmaṇy-evādhikāras te mā phaleṣhu kadāchana
mā karma-phala-hetur bhūr mā te saṅgo 'stvakarmaṇi

karmaṇi—in prescribed duties; **eva**—only; **adhikāraḥ**—right; **te**—your; **mā**—not; **phaleṣhu**—in the fruits; **kadāchana**—at any time; **mā**—never; **karma-phala**—results of the activities; **hetuḥ**—cause; **bhūḥ**—be; **mā**—not; **te**—your; **saṅgaḥ**—attachment; **astu**—must be; **akarmaṇi**—in inaction

You have the right to work only, and not to the fruits of work. Let not the fruit of action be your motive, nor let your attachment be to inaction.